



Teens (14–18)

Q

Why is blanching vegetables before freezing important?



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ANSWER

It slows enzyme activity that can cause loss of flavor, color, and texture.

FUN FACT

Blanching helps keep frozen veggies tasting fresh longer!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



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Q

What does freezer burn do to frozen foods?



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ANSWER

Dries out the food, changes texture and flavor, causing off-flavors.

FUN FACT

Freezer burn happens when air reaches your food inside the package!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

What is the best way to package seafood for freezing to prevent freezer burn?



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ANSWER

Vacuum package or wrap tightly with plastic wrap then place in a freezer bag.

FUN FACT

Removing air from packages helps keep seafood tasty and moist!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



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Q

When freezing food in glass jars, what important step should you follow?



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ANSWER

Leave at least half an inch of space at the top for ice expansion.

FUN FACT

Water expands by about 10% when it freezes, so jars can break without space.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

Why should air be excluded as much as possible from freezer packages?



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ANSWER

Air encourages oxidation and ice crystal growth that damage food quality.

FUN FACT

Big ice crystals form when air is trapped, making food mushy when thawed!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

Which vegetable is NOT recommended to freeze because it loses texture and flavor?



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ANSWER

Lettuce

FUN FACT

Lettuce becomes watery and mushy after freezing and thawing!

Source: SP 50-766 Foods that do not freeze well



Teens (14–18)

Q

At what temperature should home freezers be kept to maintain food safety?



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ANSWER

0°F (-18°C) or below

FUN FACT

Keeping your freezer at 0°F stops bacteria from growing!

Source: SP 50-677 Guidelines for the refrigeration of foods



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Q

What happens if frozen food is thawed and refrozen multiple times?



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ANSWER

Texture, color, and flavor degrade and increase risk of spoilage.

FUN FACT

Repeated thawing can cause freezer burn and spoilage faster.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



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Q

Which of these is a good way to prevent freezer burn when freezing fish?



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ANSWER

Glazing fish with a thin layer of ice before packaging.

FUN FACT

Ice glaze protects fish from drying out in the freezer!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



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Q

Why should you label frozen food packages with date and contents?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To avoid wasting food and keep track of storage times and contents.

FUN FACT

Labeling helps you use the oldest food first and reduces waste!

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



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Q

Which of these root cellar conditions helps preserve vegetables best?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Cool temperature and high humidity

FUN FACT

Too dry air causes roots to shrivel; too warm speeds spoiling!

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide



Q

What is the best way to store potatoes with other produce?



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ANSWER

Keep potatoes separate because they release gases that cause other foods to spoil.

FUN FACT

Potatoes make apples go musty and carrots bitter by releasing ethylene gas!

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide



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Q

Which of the following foods does NOT freeze well because it becomes watery or mushy?



ANSWER

High-water content fruits like watermelon

FUN FACT

Watermelon cells burst when frozen, making it soggy when thawed!

Source: SP 50-766 Foods that do not freeze well



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Q

How long can a full freezer keep food safe during a power outage?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

About 48 hours (2 days)

FUN FACT

Full freezers stay colder longer because frozen food helps keep things cold!

Source: EM 9331 Survival basics food



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Q

What is a safe way to thaw frozen foods quickly?



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ANSWER

In the refrigerator or under cold running water

FUN FACT

Using cold water or fridge keeps food safe from bacteria during thawing.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



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Q

Why is freezing considered a safe method of food preservation?



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ANSWER

It stops bacterial growth by keeping food temperature below 0°F.

FUN FACT

Freezing doesn't kill bacteria but stops them from growing and multiplying!

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Teens (14–18)

Q

Which packaging material is NOT recommended for freezer use?



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ANSWER

Regular paper that is not moisture-resistant

FUN FACT

Regular paper lets air in and causes freezer burn.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Teens (14–18)

Q

What is an effect of large ice crystals forming inside frozen food?



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ANSWER

They rupture cells, damaging texture and causing drip loss upon thawing.

FUN FACT

Slow freezing causes big ice crystals that ruin food texture.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

What is the recommended maximum amount per package when individually freezing seafood in a master bag?



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ANSWER

No more than 1 pound per master bag

FUN FACT

Smaller packages freeze and thaw faster and reduce waste.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



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Q

Why do fruits and vegetables need different freezing preparation methods?



ANSWER

Because vegetables usually need blanching; fruits do not due to acidity differences.

FUN FACT

Blanching stops enzymes in veggies but fruits are naturally acidic to resist spoilage.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables